

ROUTINES THAT STICK, FOR ANY GRADE

Classroom procedures checklist

Every classroom runs on about twenty small procedures nobody teaches on purpose — until the year one teacher does. Check off each as you explicitly teach, model, and practice it. Add the date so you know when it's time to re-teach.

Entering & starting

- ☐ How to enter the room and where to go first _____
- ☐ Where to find and start the warm-up / bell-ringer _____
- ☐ Where to put homework, notes, and permission slips _____
- ☐ What to do if you're early / what to do if you're late _____

During the lesson

- ☐ How to ask a question without raising every hand _____
- ☐ Signal for quiet / signal for attention _____
- ☐ How to get materials, sharpen a pencil, get a tissue _____
- ☐ Bathroom / water procedure _____
- ☐ What "early finisher" work looks like _____
- ☐ How group work is formed and how it starts _____

Transitions & movement

- ☐ Lining up (order, noise level, hands) _____
- ☐ Moving between activities or centers _____
- ☐ Fire drill / lockdown / emergency routes _____
- ☐ Leaving for specials, lunch, or recess _____

Turning in & wrapping up

- ☐ Where finished work goes, by subject _____
- ☐ What a missing or late assignment looks like to you _____
- ☐ End-of-day / end-of-class cleanup routine _____
- ☐ Dismissal procedure (backpack, chairs, check-out) _____

date taught

Turn any row into poster wording, with AI

The routines-to-poster prompt

"Turn these classroom procedures into short, positive, poster-ready wording for [GRADE]: [PASTE THE ROWS YOU CHECKED]. Each one under 8 words, starting with a verb, no 'don't' statements."

Nothing about a specific student ever needs to go into this prompt — it's about the room, not a child.

Keep it visible, keep it current

- **Post the poster version** where the class can see it — the AI prompt above turns any row into wall-ready wording in seconds.
- **Revisit after every break.** Routines fade over a long weekend, and they evaporate over winter or spring break — plan five minutes to re-teach, not re-explain from scratch.
- **Update the "date taught" column** whenever you re-teach a row — it becomes a quick record of what actually got reinforced this year.

Want the sub-day version of this system? Our Substitute Binder with AI turns your routines into a binder any sub can run in fifteen minutes. In our TpT store.

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